

CASE STUDY

Technical Support and SME Across Cloud, Equipment with Software

Digital Product Support Specialist (DPSS) / Subject Matter Expert, Service Team — Sous Chef Cloud Platform

Technical Support	SME / Documentation	Level 1 & 2 Escalation	Field Support	Client Relations
-------------------	---------------------	------------------------	---------------	------------------

PLATFORM Sous Chef Cloud — foodservice equipment management SaaS	CLIENT BASE Multi-brand QSR accounts (national restaurant chains)
MY ROLE Technical Support / DPSS & Service Team SME	SUPPORT TIERS OWNED Level 1 & Level 2

Overview

Sous Chef Cloud is a web-based equipment management platform used by a national foodservice equipment manufacturer to let restaurant operators register devices, configure cooking/warming programs, and monitor connectivity across thousands of locations. It's my primary area of expertise, but my support role extends beyond the cloud platform to any equipment I support that runs on software — from configuration and programming through connectivity and in-field behavior. As a Technical Support / Digital Product Support Specialist, I served as the Subject Matter Expert (SME) for the Service Team — the person the team relied on to resolve escalated issues, interpret how the platform, connected software, and hardware behaved, and translate that knowledge into documentation and training the rest of the team could use.

My Role & Responsibilities

- Provided Level 1 and Level 2 technical support for the Service Team, resolving platform issues directly and triaging what needed engineering escalation.
- Sous Chef Cloud is my core area of expertise, but my support scope covers any equipment I support that runs on software — not the cloud platform alone.
- Acted as SME for the platform's account, equipment, and connectivity workflows — the point of reference teammates went to for non-standard or ambiguous cases.
- Owned escalation for all software-connected equipment I supported, as well as the sous-chef app — serving as the go-to for issues the Service Team couldn't resolve at first line.
- Supported account creation, equipment programming, equipment registration, and network/connectivity troubleshooting for cloud-connected kitchen equipment.
- Supported field testing for counter equipment and the companion “sous-chef” mobile/field app, validating behavior before wider rollout.
- Authored documentation and training materials for the Service Team, converting tribal knowledge into repeatable, teachable processes.
- Managed direct communication with store-level and account stakeholders via 1:1 calls, email, and meetings.

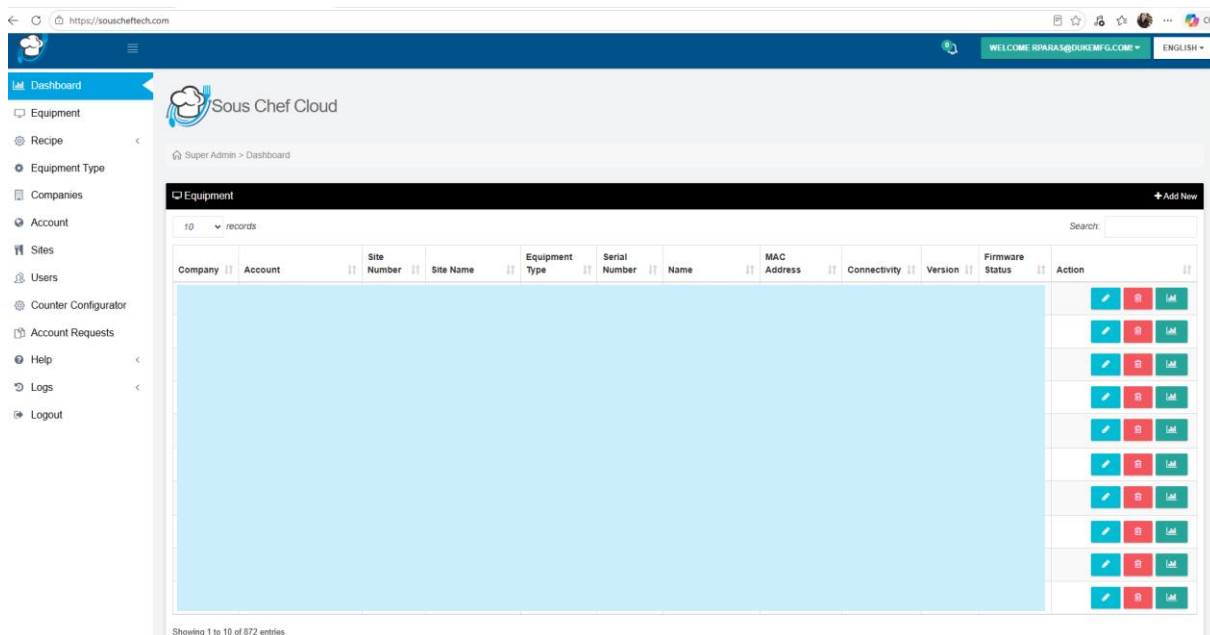
The Challenge

Equipment support platforms like this sit at the intersection of software (the cloud dashboard), hardware (physical cooking/warming units in the field), and people (store staff with varying technical comfort). Issues rarely fit a single category — a “connectivity” ticket might be a network problem, a firmware mismatch, or a configuration error made during equipment programming. The Service Team needed someone who could diagnose across that whole stack quickly, and who could document those diagnostic paths, so the team wasn't dependent on one person's memory.

What I Did

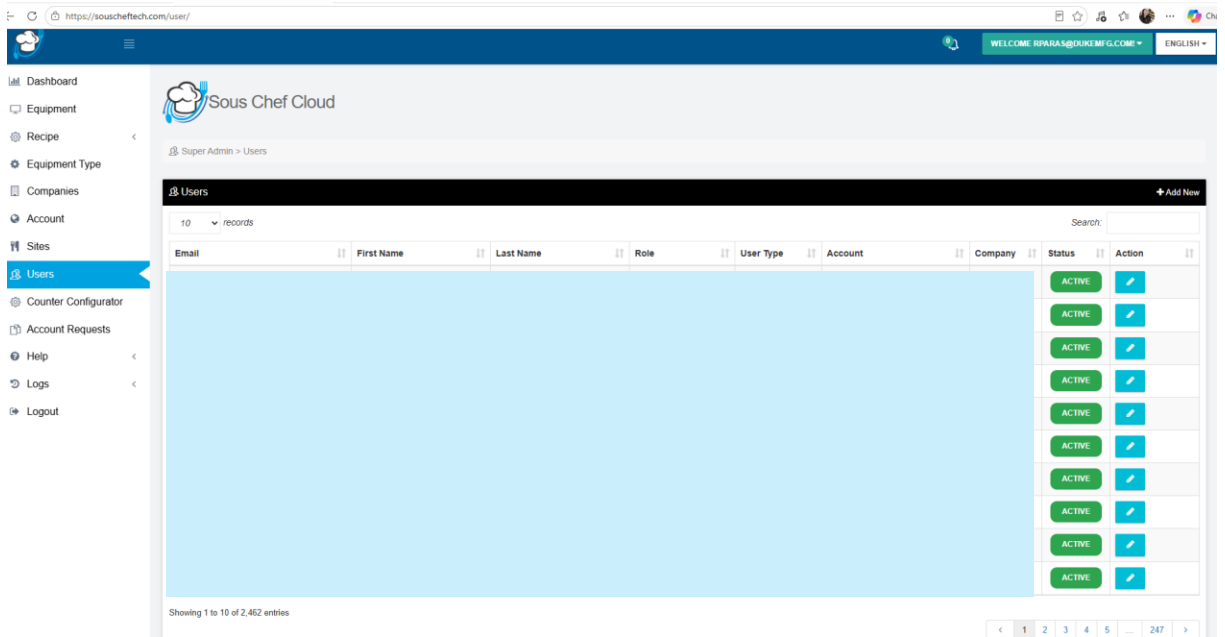
1. Platform & Equipment Support

I supported the full equipment lifecycle inside Sous Chef Cloud — from account creation through equipment registration, programming, and ongoing connectivity monitoring. The screenshots below show the two core admin views I worked in daily: the Equipment dashboard (device inventory, connectivity status, firmware) and the Users dashboard (account and access management across accounts).



Company	Account	Site Number	Site Name	Equipment Type	Serial Number	Name	MAC Address	Connectivity	Version	Firmware Status	Action
											Edit Delete Link
											Edit Delete Link
											Edit Delete Link
											Edit Delete Link
											Edit Delete Link
											Edit Delete Link
											Edit Delete Link
											Edit Delete Link
											Edit Delete Link
											Edit Delete Link

Equipment dashboard — device inventory, connectivity, and firmware status across accounts.



User/account administration view.

2. Level 1 & 2 Support for the Service Team

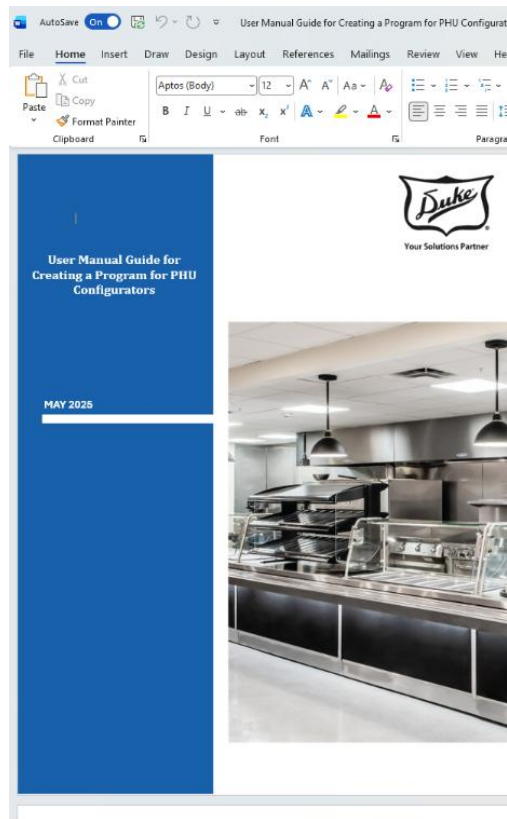
I handled escalated tickets that front-line support couldn't resolve — configuration issues, connectivity failures, and equipment behavior that didn't match expected states — and served as the internal escalation point when the rest of the Service Team hit something unfamiliar. This escalation ownership spanned every piece of software-connected equipment I supported, plus the sous-chef app itself, so the team had one consistent point of contact regardless of which device or app the issue originated from.

3. Field Testing

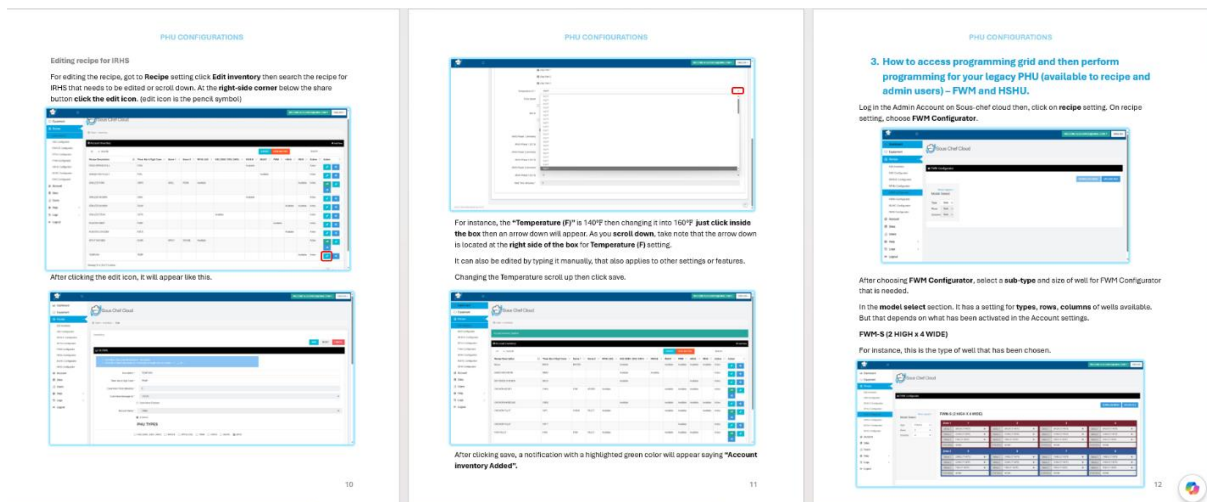
Beyond the dashboard, I supported field testing for counter equipment and the sous-chef app used in live kitchen environments, helping validate that configuration changes behaved correctly on physical hardware before they reached customers broadly.

SME Contribution: Documentation & Training

This is where the SME role stood out. Rather than solving the same issue repeatedly, I built out documentation and training material the whole Service Team could use — including a full user manual for programming PHU (Portable Holding Unit) configurators, covering every configurator type (FWM, IRHS/IRHS-E, IRHSZ, IRHSS, HSHU2, MUHC) and the recipe-programming workflow behind each one.



User Manual Guide for Creating a Program for PHU Configurators — authored as SME reference documentation.



Step-by-step configuration walkthrough from the manual, showing the level of procedural detail used to onboard and train the Service Team.

This manual became the team's reference for programming legacy and current PHU configurators — reducing how often teammates needed to escalate configuration questions directly to me, and giving new team members a self-serve path to competency.

Client-Facing Communication

Alongside internal support, I was a direct point of contact for store-level and account stakeholders — responding to inquiries via 1:1 calls, email, and meetings. This meant translating technical root causes into plain-language explanations for non-technical restaurant staff, and translating store-reported symptoms back into actionable technical detail for the team.

Impact

- Reduced repeat escalations to me personally by giving the Service Team a documented, self-serve reference for PHU configuration — [add: % reduction or time saved once available].
- Shortened new-hire ramp time on configurator programming by replacing verbal/tribal knowledge with a structured manual — [add: ramp time before vs. after, if known].
- Maintained platform reliability across a large, multi-brand account base by combining Level 1/2 support with proactive field validation — [add: ticket volume, resolution time, or account count if available].

(Bracketed items are placeholders — drop in real numbers where you have them; even rough estimates make this section much stronger for a portfolio reader.)

Skills Demonstrated

- Technical troubleshooting across software, hardware, and network layers
- Level 1/2 support ownership and escalation triage
- Subject Matter Expert (SME) knowledge ownership within a service team
- Technical documentation and training material authorship
- Field testing and pre-release validation
- Client-facing communication across calls, email, and meetings
- Cross-functional collaboration between support, field, and account teams